



Used lens?

In the market for a used lens?
Check out smugmug's blog here
<http://smu.gs/nG6XRk>



Crystal clear!

Learn how to clean your camera lenses properly. All you need is a set of lungs and a cloth <http://smu.gs/oZ5hER>

Accessorise your dSLR

This DIY will enable you to create one of the most basic and essential accessories for your dSLR

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Photography is a form of art. It isn't just about taking a picture or cataloging a memory, it's an expression of your vision – your vision of what the scene in front of you can be. The function of a photographer is to bring this vision to life. In the days of film, photographers had to rely almost entirely on their experience to assist them in realising this vision. Now, with the advent and proliferation of digital cameras, this task has become much easier. The instant feedback gives us the ability to review our images on the fly and helps perfect the image to match our vision.

Among these various tools is a small, underrated little tool known as a remote shutter release. The main function of this tool is to release the shutter of the camera without the operator actually touching the camera. This might not seem like much, but when it comes to images with slow shutter speeds, every tiny vibration can have a drastic impact on the image. Mounting on a tripod does help, but when it's the pressure of the photographer's finger that can cause the

vibrations in the first place, the remote trigger comes in very handy.

Remote shutter release

Consider a situation where you want to take photographs of lightning, or better yet, as Diwali is around the corner, fireworks, especially the rockets. The ideal way to go about this is to set up a tripod and mount your camera ensuring that it's pointing at the night sky where you expect the said lightning or rocket to explode into existence with all its fierceness and glorious brilliance!

Capturing this moment requires setting the camera on a tripod in "bulb" mode and releasing the shutter at the correct time; then waiting for the event to pass and then letting the shutter close. The longer the shutter exposure, the longer your streamers will be. This is a simple enough task on paper, but when you realize that you have to stand absolutely still for 7-10 seconds with your finger on the shutter release of your camera, you realize that there is a very real chance of ruining the image with unexpected vibrations. It is in situations like these where the remote shutter release will come in very handy.

Tips

Hunting around for the parts presented no problem; most of them were available at local electronics and mobile repair shops. We did run into some trouble while trying to construct the trigger. As you'll see on the next page, you require 2.5mm to 3.5mm headphone adapters. Unfortunately, the first pair we bought turned out to be a mono adapter when we actually needed a stereo adapter. The lesson here: make absolutely sure that you have a stereo adapter and a stereo line-in line-out cable. To verify, use a multimeter and do a continuity check, or just plug in some earphones and listen to a track which you know has stereo sound.

DIY

After a bit of delving around we found the approximate cost of a wired remote shutter to be in the range of ₹1500. Being Digitians and fiddle-some by nature, we dug around a bit more and found that the trigger circuitry is actually very simple to reproduce. Simple enough for a Digit DIY. Cost? Not more than ₹200.

The internet is choc-a-bloc with many designs for making a simple remote trigger. After a bit of brainstorming, we settled on one for the convenience of having a modular design and the ability to extend the cable as much as is required. 